

UNIVERSAL TOKEN SYSTEM • PHASE 1

# What you see is what it means.

*Self-describing color tokens for the categorical layer — same pixels, clearer names, no magic.*

# The categorical vocabulary, by role.

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## **cat-N-fill**

Background. The pale categorical surface a band sits on (was `--cN-light`).

## **cat-N-mark**

Foreground. The saturated stroke, mark, or cScale feed (was `--cN-dark`).

## **cat-on-fill**

Foreground. Ink for text placed on a fill (was `--c-ink-light`).

## **cat-on-mark**

Foreground. Ink for text placed on a mark (was `--c-ink-dark`).

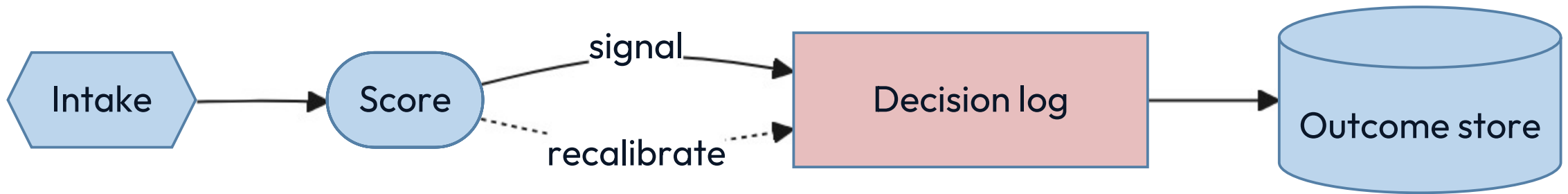
# Foreground or background — never ambiguous.

## *The pairing law*

A background takes the bare role name; a foreground names the background it reads against with `on-`. Color-scheme lives only inside the `light-dark()` value, never in a token name.

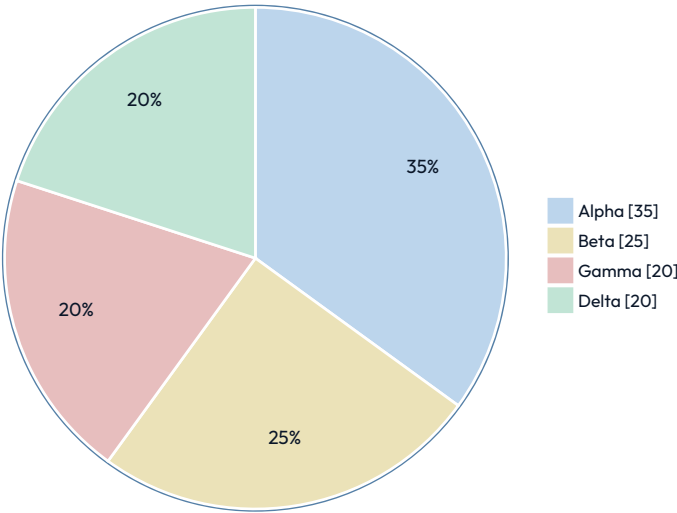
## 01 • FLOWCHART

## Band fills and strokes resolve through the new names.

**KEY INSIGHT**

Node fills read `--cat-1-fill`; borders read the structural stroke — both painted via the upgraded offline bridge.

# Categorical marks across the cycle.

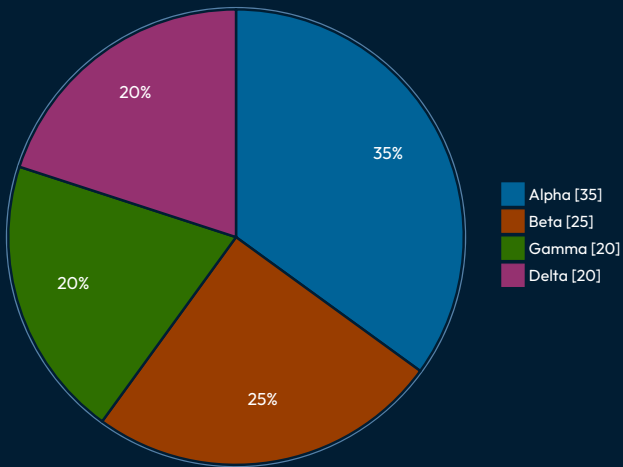


KEY INSIGHT

Wedges cycle `--cat-1-mark` ... `--cat-4-mark`; the percentage labels read `--cat-on-fill`.

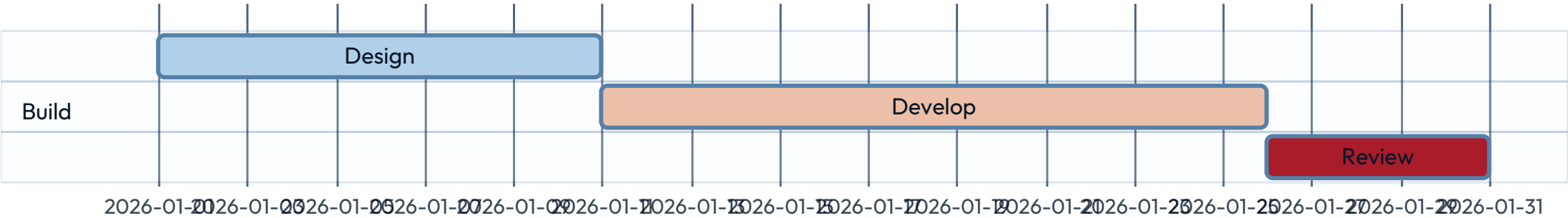
## 03 · PIE, DARK CANVAS

# The same names, dark branch.

**KEY INSIGHT**

One token, both schemes: `light-dark()` inside each `--cat-*` value resolves to the dark branch here — proof the new names carry the scheme, not the name.

# Categorical fills and semantic states, side by side.



KEY INSIGHT

Task fills read `--cat-1-fill`; done / active / crit read the semantic states (a separate group, unchanged this phase).

PHASE 1 OF 7 · SEE [ENGINEERING/DECISIONS/2026-06-11-UNIVERSAL-TOKEN-SYSTEM.MD](#)

Byte-identical today;  
scalable tomorrow.